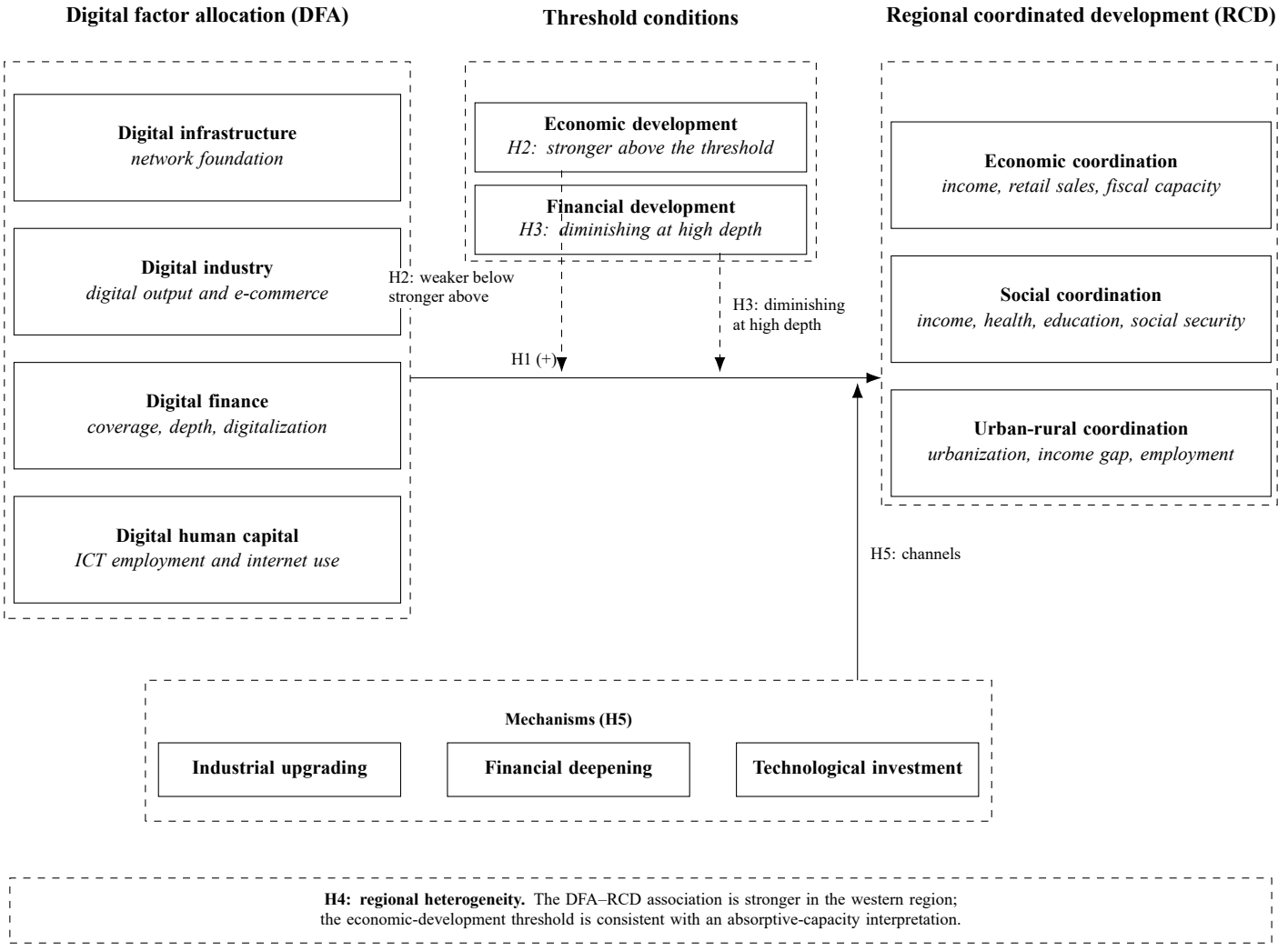

Digital factor allocation (DFA)
Threshold conditions
Regional coordinated development (RCD)
Digital infrastructure
network foundation
Digital industry
digital output and e-commerce
Digital finance
coverage, depth, digitalization
Digital human capital
ICT employment and internet use
Economic development
H2: stronger above the threshold
Financial development
H3: diminishing at high depth
H2: weaker below
stronger above
H3: diminishing
at high depth
H1 (+)
Economic coordination
income, retail sales, fiscal capacity
Social coordination
income, health, education, social security
Urban-rural coordination
urbanization, income gap, employment
H5: channels
Mechanisms (H5)
Industrial upgrading
Financial deepening
Technological investment
H4: regional heterogeneity. The DFA–RCD association is stronger in the western region;
the economic-development threshold is consistent with an absorptive-capacity interpretation.